

points, which is right up there with other Snapdragon 8 Gen 2-powered smartphones. For perspective, the Galaxy Z Flip5 beats the Samsung Galaxy S23 and comes a bit behind the Samsung Galaxy S23 Ultra. Further, the smartphone comfortably beats both its rivals - the Oppo Find N2 Flip and the Moto Razr 40 Ultra.

On Geekbench, the smartphone scored 1917 points in the single core test, and 4868 points in the multi-core test. Further, in PCMark Work 3.0, which is another CPU-based benchmark, the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip5 scored 14,872 points which is again very good and at par with other Snapdragon 8 Gen 2-powered smartphones. For comparisons sake, this is again better than the other two flip smartphones of 2023, the Oppo Find N2 Flip and the Moto Razr 40 Ultra. Just the Razr 40 Ultra beats the Galaxy Z Flip5 in PCMark Work 3.0.

In GPU-based tests as well, the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip5 performed well, coming close to the big brother, the Samsung Galaxy Z Fold 5 and the Galaxy S23 Ultra and marginally beating the Samsung Galaxy S23. So in terms of benchmarks and tests we ran on the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip5, the smartphone performs as well as any other Samsung flagship of this year.

Coming to real-world performance, the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip5 never felt slow or lacking in any sense. The smartphone is snappy, it's quick and best of all, the start-up time is brilliant. While gaming also, I didn't experience any frame drops or lags. Just the tall aspect ratio isn't exactly ideal for those who game a lot on their device.

One thing I noticed with the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip5 is that the smartphone heats up quite a bit. At times, the Galaxy Z Flip5 just started heating up in my pocket and I was left wondering as to why that is happening. While gaming, however, the smartphone manages thermals pretty well. Given the weird heating patterns, I ran the CPU throttling test, and the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip5 throttled a bit. The smartphone throttled to 62 percent of the CPU performance in my test so that is not great.

Overall, the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip5 performs as well as any other flagship smartphone. It is super quick, super responsive, and it runs games smoothly.

BATTERY

Coming to battery, during normal usage, I wasn't blown away by the battery backup. Yes, it has improved from last year, but it's not a dramatic improvement.

In our tests, however, the results were good. The Samsung Galaxy Z Flip5 lasted a good 770 minutes in our video loop test, meaning that the smartphone went on for just under 13 hours (12 hours 50 minutes), which is pretty good.

The charging is also slow at 25W. For a 3,700mAh battery, it charges from 0 to 100 percent in 93 minutes. In today's era, when we have smartphones that charge in just about 30 minutes, this feels super slow and takes almost forever to charge to a full 100 percent.

CAMERA

Optics wise also, the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip5 doesn't seem too impressive on paper. In fact, the camera setup is the same as last year's Samsung Galaxy Z Flip4. The smartphone has a dual rear camera setup with a primary 12-megapixel wide angle shooter and another 12-megapixel ultra-wide angle shooter. Up front, we get a 10-megapixel selfie snapper.

The images from the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip5's camera are flagship-level. The photos from this camera have brilliant dynamic range, making scenic shots look stunning. The colours are more on the saturated side, not very true to life, but then again, that is something that most users actually prefer over true-to-life images.

In terms of details also, the photos from the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip5 are very good. I took a lot of shots in different environments on this smartphone and every time, I was impressed with the amount of detail this primary 12-megapixel shooter was able to put out. The images are sharp and very vibrant.

The portrait mode is also very good. I found no issues with the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip5's edge detection or background blur. Even in wide angle, the shots are as sharp and detailed as the primary shooter, just the colours aren't very consistent. The difference is only minor and at times in ideal lighting conditions, I found the colours to be a

bit more towards my taste in wide angle shots. Overall, this is a flagship-level camera setup by all definitions. The images are crisp, sharp, and detailed, showcasing great dynamic range at all times. It does portraits well, and the ultra-wide angle shooter is in-line with the primary shooter in terms of the quality of images. Good stuff.

VERDICT

So that was my detailed review of the Samsung Galaxy Z Flip5. This, by all means, is the most refined flip smartphone in the market right now. Samsung's new approach towards this form factor has worked extremely well for the brand.

Yes, we saw a similar implementation with the Moto Razr 40 Ultra. In fact, the outer display and software on the Moto Razr 40 Ultra is much better, but with a bit of effort, you can also bring a similar experience to this 3.4-inch cover display. The important thing to note here is that this kind of an outer display implementation will possibly extend the smartphone's life, since people won't be opening their smartphone for every other task.

What Samsung has done better is refinement. The Samsung Galaxy Z Flip5 feels like a much more complete phone. It feels sturdy, it feels premium, and it makes me feel confident about holding the smartphone. The hinge is smooth through and through, and there is no wobble given the excellent build quality that Samsung has showcased here. So yes, it does everything every other flip smartphone of 2023 does, along with offering the best build quality, design, and the best software experience with Samsung's promise to bring 4 OS updates to its flagship smartphones.

-Darab Mansoor Ali

SPECIFICATIONS

IPX8 | OS: Android 13, One UI 5.1.1 |
Chipset: Qualcomm Snapdragon 8 Gen 2 (4 nm) |
GPU: Adreno 740 | Internal: 256GB 8GB RAM,
512GB 8GB RAM | Main Camera: Dual 12 MP, Dual
Pixel PDAF, OIS, 12 MP, f/2.2, 123° (ultrawide) |
Selfie Camera: 10 MP, f/2.2, 23mm (wide)

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